

Presentation and Speaking Skills

Open

EPS30

This course emphasizes the knowledge and skills required to plan and make effective presentations and to speak effectively in both formal and informal contexts, using such forms as reports, speeches, debates, panel discussions, storytelling, recitations, interviews, and multimedia presentations. Students will research and analyse the content and characteristics of convincing speeches and the techniques of effective speakers; design and rehearse presentations for a variety of purposes and audiences; select and use visual and technological aids to enhance their message; and assess the effectiveness of their own and others' presentations.

Prerequisite: English, Grade 10, Academic or Applied

Strands

The expectations in this course are organized into the following strands:

- A. Understanding Presentations
- B. Making Presentations

A. UNDERSTANDING PRESENTATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- 1. Identifying Elements of Effective Presentations:** identify and analyse the characteristics of effective presentations;
- 2. Assessing Presentations:** produce critical assessments of a variety of presentations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

1. Identifying Elements of Effective Presentations

By the end of this course, students will:

Identifying Forms

- 1.1** identify a variety of presentation forms (e.g., oral reports, speeches, lectures, debates, public address announcements, panel discussions, book discussions, storytelling, recitations, role plays, seminars, sales presentations, interviews, multi-media presentations)

Teacher prompts: “How do different types of speeches suit different purposes?” “How would you define a ‘speech’?”

Identifying Elements of Style and Organization

- 1.2** identify elements of style, stylistic devices, and organization in selected speeches or debates by famous orators (e.g., identify examples of repetition, rhetorical questions, and climactic order in excerpts from selected speeches; identify how a speaker uses tone to engage an audience; identify the use of repetition for emphasis in an anecdote; compare the use of the narrative and poetic elements in a medieval and a contemporary ballad)

Teacher prompts: “What is the effect of that rhetorical question?” “What stylistic devices do you see the speaker using in this presentation?”

Identifying Performance Techniques

- 1.3** identify the techniques that effective speakers use to make convincing presentations (e.g., describe the body language and vocal inflections used in a motivational speech; explain how factors such as volume, pace of speech, pitch, tone of voice, eye contact, facial expressions, posture,

dress, movement, and gestures reinforce meaning in presentations; identify how the use of periodic summations, transition words, and humour engage an audience and sustain the audience’s interest; explain the use of visuals to persuade in a sales presentation)

Teacher prompt: “What is the speaker doing to influence the audience’s response?”

Identifying the Uses of Audio-Visual Aids

- 1.4** identify how audio-visual aids are used to support the oral components of a presentation (e.g., explain the use of presentation software to emphasize key points in a sales presentation; identify how charts and graphs are used to reinforce specific elements in an oral presentation; explain how and when audio clips should be used to vary the pace in a presentation)

Teacher prompts: “Were the visual aids effective or distracting?” “How many video clips could you use before you begin to lose your audience?”

Identifying Cultural Conventions

- 1.5** describe conventions of oral and non-verbal communication in various cultures and how these conventions affect the delivery of oral presentations (e.g., find and discuss information about how different cultures view the use of eye contact and body language during presentations; research the training and protocols associated with Aboriginal storytelling; compare and contrast the use of kissing as a greeting in various cultures)

Teacher prompts: “What cultural conventions did you observe in the speaker’s performance?” “How well would this speaker communicate with an audience outside of North America?”

2. Assessing Presentations

By the end of this course, students will:

Effective Listening

- 2.1** use techniques of effective listening and note-taking to understand the ideas and information given in presentations (*e.g., identify what they hope to learn from a lecture; make notes to record key points and organization during a speech; identify the implications and consequences of information provided in a presentation*)

Teacher prompts: “What techniques did you use when you listened to your peer’s presentation? How effective were the techniques you used?” “What key points did the speaker make?”

Evaluating Form and Content

- 2.2** assess the appropriateness of the chosen form and the effectiveness of a presenter’s ideas, in view of the topic, audience, and purpose of the presentation (*e.g., assess the extent to which the needs of the audience have been met by the content and form of a presentation; use an evaluation checklist to assess clarity of arguments, persuasiveness, and quality of refutations in a debate; identify logical fallacies in oral presentations and assess the extent to which they undermine the credibility of the speaker’s message; use a graphic organizer to track and evaluate the organization of the ideas in a presentation*)

Teacher prompts: “How effective was the speaker in convincing you of his/her opinion?” “Was there sufficient evidence on which to base a reasonable conclusion?” “Was the form of the presentation appropriate for the content and audience?”

Evaluating Style and Organization

- 2.3** assess the style and organization of a presentation (*e.g., assess the structure of a presentation; assess the use of stylistic elements, such as humour and tone, to engage an audience*)

Teacher prompt: “Are there other structures that could be used? Why would they be more effective or less effective than the current structure?”

Evaluating Delivery

- 2.4** assess the effectiveness of the presentation techniques and audio-visual aids used in an oral presentation (*e.g., discuss in a group the three most effective techniques used in a presentation; develop criteria on which to base an assessment of a presenter’s use of voice and gestures; evaluate the effectiveness of the audio-visual aids used in a presentation*)

Teacher prompts: “What did the speaker do particularly well in delivering this speech? What did you observe about his speaking style that you would like to try in your own presentations?” “Were audio-visual aids overused or underused in the presentation? Why do you say that?”

Communicating Feedback to Peers

- 2.5** provide objective and constructive feedback on presentation rehearsals and presentations by peers (*e.g., develop a process and vocabulary for providing constructive feedback; work with a partner to make a T-chart of strengths and weaknesses during the rehearsal of a presentation; use peer conferences and checklists of specific criteria to provide feedback after presentations*)

Teacher prompt: “How can you give the presenter your feedback in a way that will help her to see both strengths and weaknesses in a constructive and positive manner?”

B. MAKING PRESENTATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- 1. Planning Presentations:** plan presentations for specific purposes and audiences;
- 2. Delivering Presentations:** communicate orally for a variety of purposes and audiences, using the forms, language, and techniques of effective oral presentations;
- 3. Reflecting on Presentation Skills and Strategies:** reflect on the skills they have acquired in preparing, delivering, and responding to presentations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

1. Planning Presentations

By the end of this course, students will:

Selecting Appropriate Forms

- 1.1** select appropriate oral presentation forms for various purposes and audiences (*e.g., a story-telling session to entertain a class at an elementary school; an oral recitation of a poem in a class presentation on a poet; a persuasive argument on why they should be allowed to borrow the family car for an outing; a group presentation on drunk driving for a high school audience; a presentation to the school council, with a question-and-answer component, to encourage parental support for a student initiative*)

Teacher prompt: “What form will you use? Why? What other options did you consider?”

Group Planning Skills

- 1.2** identify the attributes required to successfully plan a presentation as a group, and participate in a group to plan a presentation (*e.g., role-play various characteristics that individuals may bring to a group and discuss the contribution that each characteristic makes to the success of a team; identify behaviours and speaking patterns that are counter-productive to developing a team presentation; examine how group members can share tasks in the investigation of a topic; identify the advantages of a cooperative approach in areas such as sharing the workload, communicating about strategies, and using each member’s strengths*)

Teacher prompts: “What helped your group work together effectively?” “How did you

contribute to the preparation of your group’s presentation?”

Planning for an Audience

- 1.3** identify the considerations that are important with respect to audience and venue when planning an oral presentation (*e.g., make a floor plan of the presentation venue to decide on the best use of the space; select visual aids and technology for a multimedia presentation that are appropriate for the size and composition of the audience; identify the prior knowledge, assumptions, expectations, and attention span of the audience in order to customise a presentation on a book; determine how best to allot the available time to allow for audience participation and a question-and-answer session*)

Teacher prompts: “How will you compensate for the fact that the audience does not know much about this topic?” “What can you do to make the presentation more accessible for English language learners?”

Research

- 1.4** select relevant and significant information from research to suit the topic, purpose, and audience (*e.g., gather relevant information about healthy lifestyles to engage a teenaged audience; select and research a specific topic related to workplace safety, taking into account the prior knowledge and needs of co-workers; research what college programs match particular skills and interests in preparation for a class presentation*)

Teacher prompts: “How will you know when you have done enough research?” “What else would a teenaged audience want to know about this topic?”

Developing Content and Structure

- 1.5** apply knowledge of the characteristics of effective presentations to plan content and structure for presentations to several different audiences (*e.g., create an agenda for a presentation to persuade the school board to rename the school; begin a speech with a startling statistic to engage the interest of an audience of peers; search the Internet for images that may be downloaded and used in a slide presentation about a global issue for an audience of elementary students*)

Teacher prompts: “How will you engage the audience when you begin your speech?”
“What visuals would be an effective backdrop to your presentation?”

Rehearsing

- 1.6** select and use effective rehearsal strategies to practise and polish a presentation (*e.g., practise a speech in front of peers or family members; rehearse a panel discussion or a group presentation to refine sequencing and transitions; rehearse the use of visual aids and software; test the compatibility of technology in the presentation venue*)

Teacher prompt: “What is your most effective rehearsal technique? What new rehearsal technique would you like to try?”

Building Confidence

- 1.7** use appropriate strategies to increase confidence (*e.g., memorization, repeated rehearsals, appropriate dress, relaxation and breathing exercises, mnemonic devices, visualization*)

Teacher prompts: “What will help you to feel most prepared in front of the audience?” “What sorts of cues will you need to keep on track?”

2. Delivering Presentations

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose and Audience

- 2.1** make presentations in a variety of forms for various purposes and audiences (*e.g., debate a topical issue at a student assembly; tell a story to a younger audience; role-play a job interview; present a monologue adapted from a novel; make a multimedia presentation to promote a school trip*)

Teacher prompts: “What could you do to develop your skills as a speaker?” “What opportunities are there for you to make presentations outside of class?”

Language

- 2.2** use appropriate and effective language in oral presentations (*e.g., use specialized language in a*

product or skill demonstration; use imagery or analogy to emphasize and clarify key points; use non-discriminatory and inclusive language consistently; describe a language choice they made in a presentation and explain why it was effective)

Teacher prompt: “Is there another way to phrase this sentence to make it more inclusive?”

Presentation Techniques

- 2.3** use appropriate techniques in both individual and group oral presentations (*e.g., use appropriate transitions between group members when delivering a presentation; use techniques such as rhetorical questions, humour, repetition, and dramatic pauses to engage the audience in a speech promoting a student-operated business; speak at an appropriate pace in a student seminar to allow the audience to take notes; vary volume, pitch, and inflection for emphasis and to maintain audience interest in an oral report*)

Teacher prompt: “What interesting touches were there in your delivery? Think about something as basic as volume or pace of speaking.”

Audio-Visual Aids

- 2.4** select, create, and use appropriate audio-visual aids using available technology (*e.g., use an agenda, flipchart, posters, transparencies, slides, videos, tables, or graphs to organize and clarify meaning in presentations; make appropriate design choices, including font size and colour; prepare concise handouts for an audience; use a sound recording of a poem to enhance a presentation during a seminar on poetry; create animated graphics to emphasize a key point in a sales presentation; use a videotape of a news clip to illustrate a report on a current issue; use recorded music and slides to create atmosphere during storytelling*)

Teacher prompts: “What would be an appropriate aid for a presentation on this topic?” “What type of aid would help your audience to more clearly understand the complexity of the point you want to make?” “Where can you most effectively use technology to enhance your presentation? At what point would it become a distraction?”

Responding to Audiences

- 2.5** monitor audience reactions during a presentation and adapt delivery accordingly (*e.g., ask questions to check audience understanding and engagement; rephrase main ideas for clarification; move on to the next major point quickly to recapture the attention of a restless audience; add humour to reinforce and emphasize key*

points; respond quickly, confidently, and appropriately to unexpected digressions, interruptions, or questions during the presentation)

Teacher prompts: “What can you do when you see that your audience is less engaged than you would hope?” “How can you adapt your stand-up comedy act if your audience is not laughing?”

3. Reflecting on Presentation Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

- 3.1** identify the skills they have acquired in making and assessing presentations, and create a plan for improvement (*e.g., identify the strategies and skills learned in this course that have helped them become more effective presenters; identify the feedback received from a peer that was most helpful in improving a presentation; write a critique of one of their own recent presentations, list possible improvements, and practise the skills needed to make those improvements; identify speaking and presentation skills they will need in careers that are of interest to them*)

Teacher prompts: “What has worked for you in recent presentations?” “What would you like to improve about your presentation style or preparation?” “What have you learned from your analysis of other presentations that has made you a better presenter?”